

Out of Office Email Policy

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to ensure consistent communication with colleagues, clients, and partners when employees are unavailable. An effective out of office (OOO) message helps maintain service standards, minimize delays, and direct inquiries appropriately during absences.

1. When to Set an Out of Office Message (Internally and Externally)

Employees must set an out of office email reply whenever they will be unavailable for ½ of a standard **business day or longer** due to vacation, illness, training, leave, or travel. Short-term absences (e.g., a few hours) do not typically require an automatic reply, but employees should communicate expected delays as appropriate.

2. Required Information in Out of Office Messages

All out of office messages must include the following details:

- **Date Range of Absence**
Clearly state your first and last day away from work, and when you will return (e.g., “I will be out of the office from November 4 through November 8 and will return on November 11.”).
- **Availability Status**
Indicate whether you will:
 - Have **no access** to email during your absence, or
 - Have **limited or intermittent access** (and how often you expect to check messages, if applicable).
- **Alternative Contact for Support or generic inbox details, as applicable**
Provide the name, role, and contact information of a colleague or manager who can assist in your absence (e.g., “For urgent matters, please contact [Name, Title] at [email/phone number].”).

3. Tone and Professionalism

Messages should be polite, concise, and professional. Do not include personal details or informal language.

4. Responsibility

It is each employee’s responsibility to:

- Notify managers and key stakeholders as appropriate well in advance of taking time off, where possible and in line with the time off policy for your location (refer to Handbook) and before putting the formal request into the leave administration system that applies to you for final approval (PSA, PEP, ADP, SharePoint Tracker, etc.)
- Activate your out-of-office message **before** leaving.
- Update your calendar status accordingly.

Supervisors should ensure coverage is arranged for any essential tasks during absences.

5. Compliance

All employees are expected to adhere to this policy to support consistent communication and business continuity.

6. Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

- **Monitoring and Accountability**

Supervisors are responsible for ensuring their team members set appropriate Out-Of -Office messages during absences. If an employee fails to comply with this policy, supervisors are expected to issue a **written reminder** and guidance to reinforce expectations for the employee to acknowledge.

- **Repeated Non-Compliance**

Repeated failure to comply may result in **formal corrective action**, which could include a **written warning** or notation in the employee's performance record. Please contact Human Resources for support in handling non-compliance.

Please use the correct HR Dept DL for your location:

HRdept@prolifics.com (Canada, Germany, United Kingdom, and United States)

Indiahrhelpdesk@prolifics.com (India)

Example Template:

Subject: Out of Office: [Your Name]

Thank you for your message. I am out of the office from [Start Date] through [End Date] and will return on [Return Date].

During this time, I will [not have access to email / have limited access to email].

For immediate assistance, please contact [Colleague's Name, Title] at [email address] or [phone number].

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Your Title]

[Company Name]

Eff 1 April 2026

Best Regards,
HR Department.